Document: Irish compromise on animal transport fails

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By Agnes Rønberg · Nov 13, 2026, 2:57 PM · View in your browser

Dublin’s latest compromise text and annexes on overhauling animal transport rules failed to bridge divides in the Council on Friday, two EU diplomats said.

The draft, obtained by POLITICO, shows how the latest months of negotiations have diluted the new rulebook, meant to improve animal welfare, to get skeptical countries on board. It still fell flat.

At the end of October, France, Spain, Portugal and Italy agreed to form a blocking minority to demand that much of the rules should stay as the original 2005 rules. Ireland’s latest draft is an attempt at further limiting the impact on the farming and transport sector. If just one of those countries agreed to the text, a compromise could be in sight.

Among the changes are extensions on transport times for young animals and rabbits, as POLITICO reported earlier this week. The new text, dated November 6, and circulated to delegations on Monday, offers suggestions for how that would work in practice.

Agriculture and Food Mobility

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